



## Clear Desks and Clear Screens (Answers)

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens



Welcome to this module on  
CLEAR DESK AND CLEAR SCREEN POLICY

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Overview

Maintaining a clean desk, or a clear computer screen is important – both from a productivity and security perspective.

### An uncluttered desk:



Helps you organise your work materials and time is not lost locating stuff



Secures organisational data against theft



Can help control accidents such as fires (loose items catch fire easily)

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Learning objectives



In this module, you will learn:

- The need for a Clear Desk and Clear Screen Policy
- Security concerns that arise when the policy is not adhered to
- Best practices to follow



# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Why do we need a policy?

The clear desk and clear screen policy is necessary to ensure that sensitive information - in both digital and physical forms, and even assets such as laptops, mobile phones, tablets - is safe and secure.

Such information or assets should not be left unguarded at personal or public workspaces, and you should exert caution while taking a break or leaving work for the day.





# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Why do we need a policy?



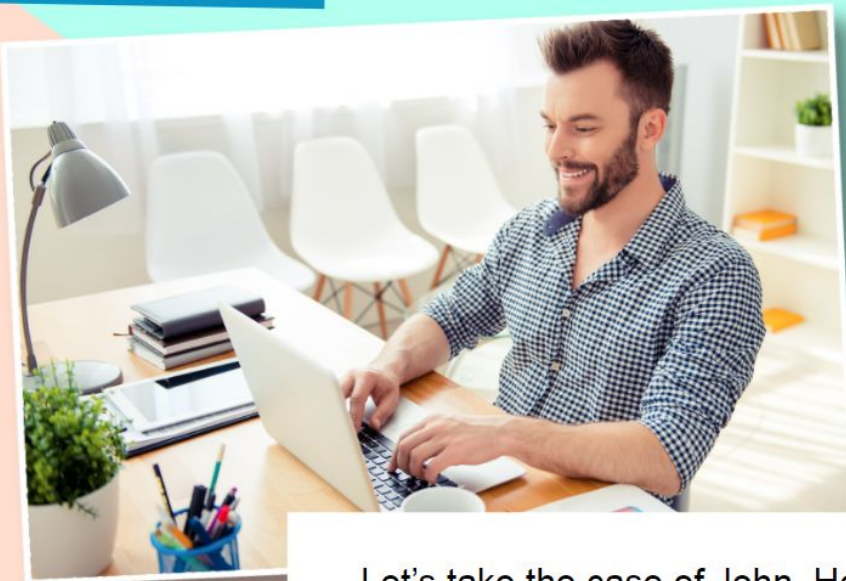
Information and assets are vulnerable even in your own workspace due to negligence of the information owner and custodian, and organisations depend heavily on the adoption of a clear desk and clear screen policy as one of the strategies in mitigating the information security risk from end users.



What, then, are these security risks? Let's find out!

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns

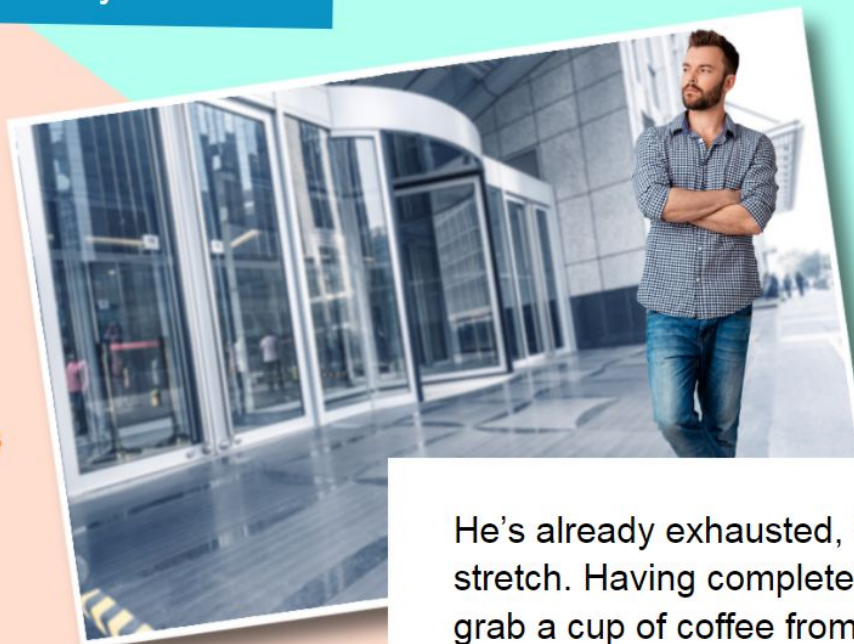


Let's take the case of John. He has an important presentation today, related to the company financials.

In fact, just so that he could finish the presentation well on time, he came in early to work on it – and now he's finally done with it, with a couple of hours to spare!

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns



He's already exhausted, having worked four hours at a stretch. Having completed the presentation, he decides to grab a cup of coffee from the café across the street.

Here's John, stepping out of office for a quick caffeine fix...



# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns

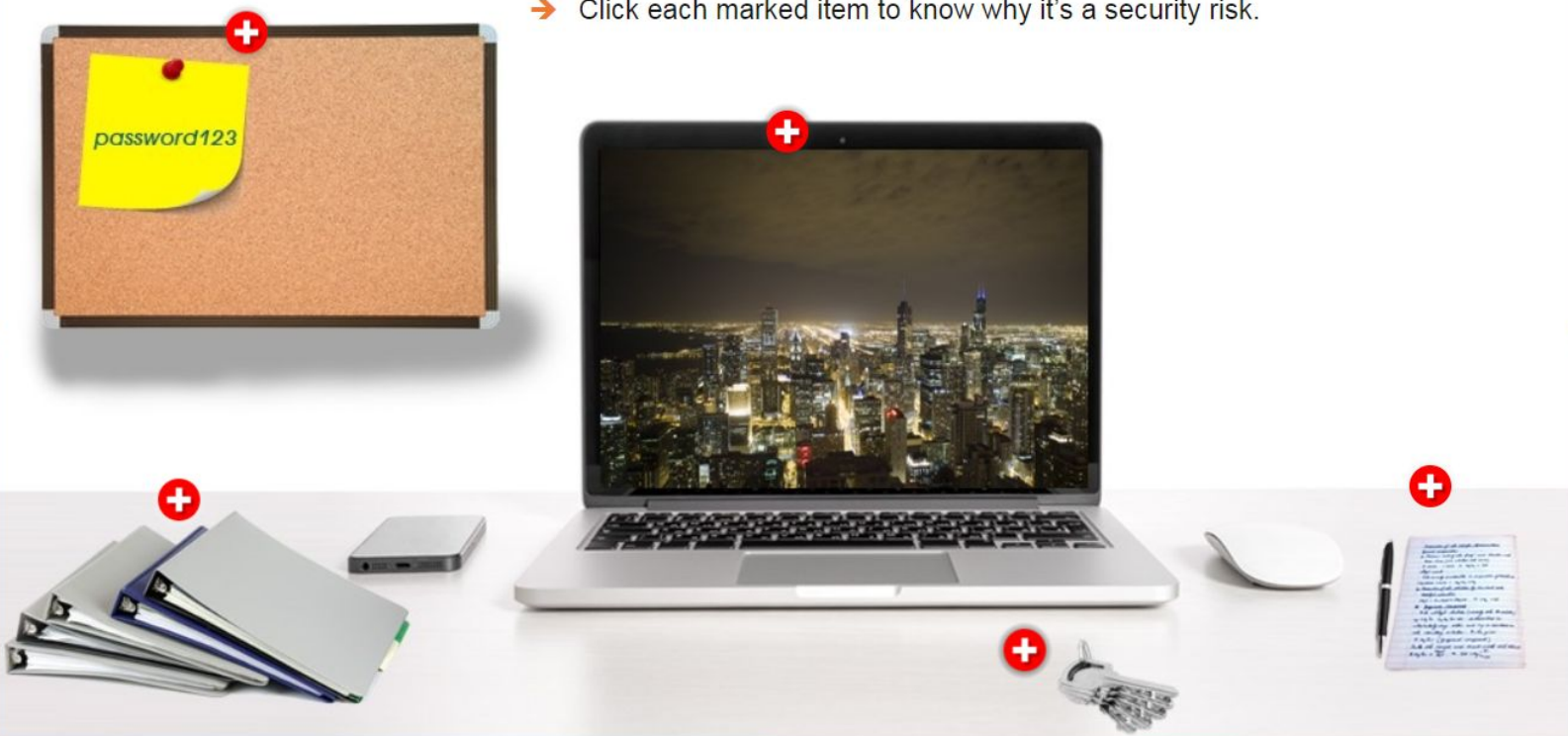


And here's his workspace, all cluttered with VERY IMPORTANT information. Oh, John! How could you?!

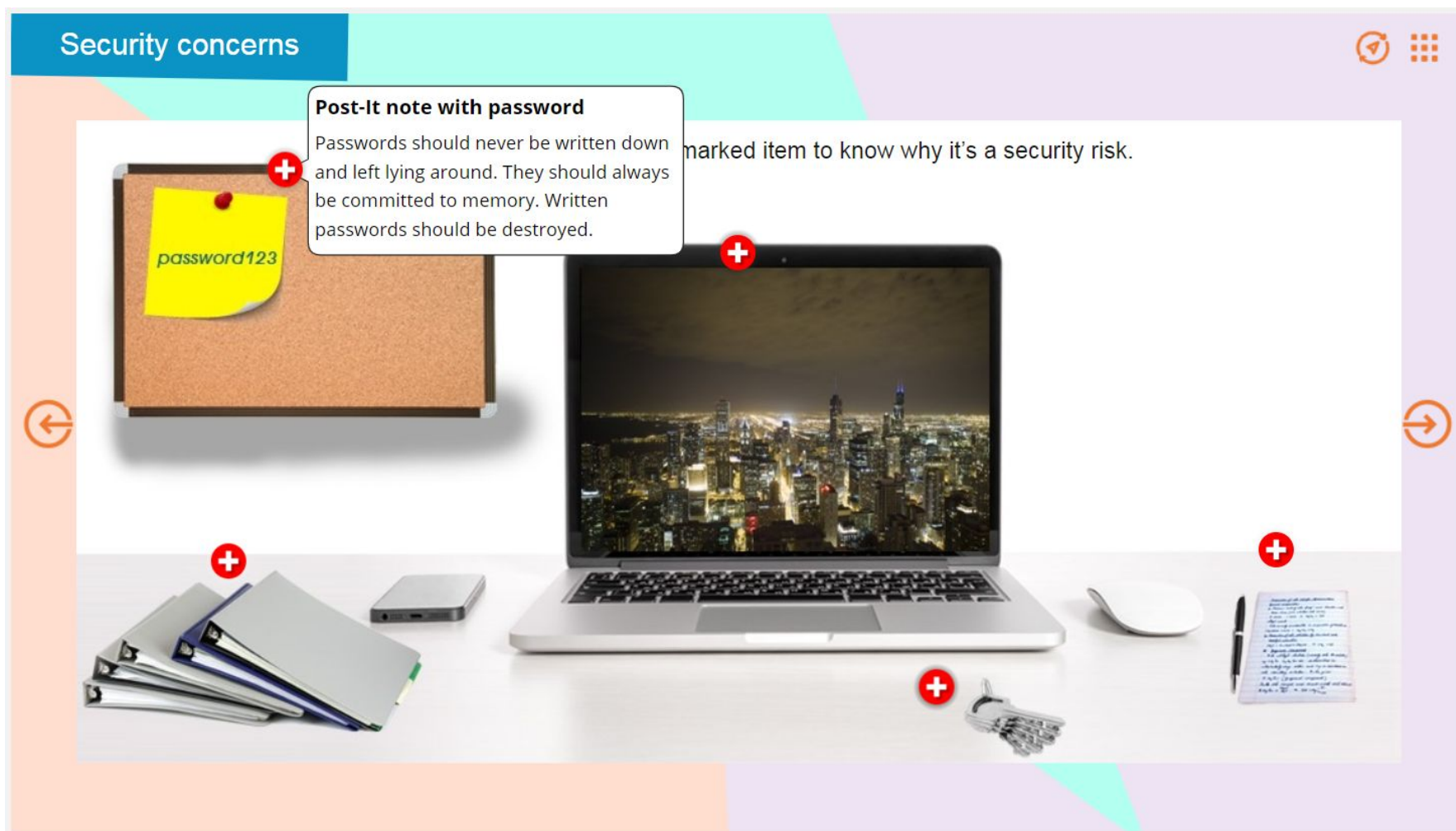
# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns

→ Click each marked item to know why it's a security risk.



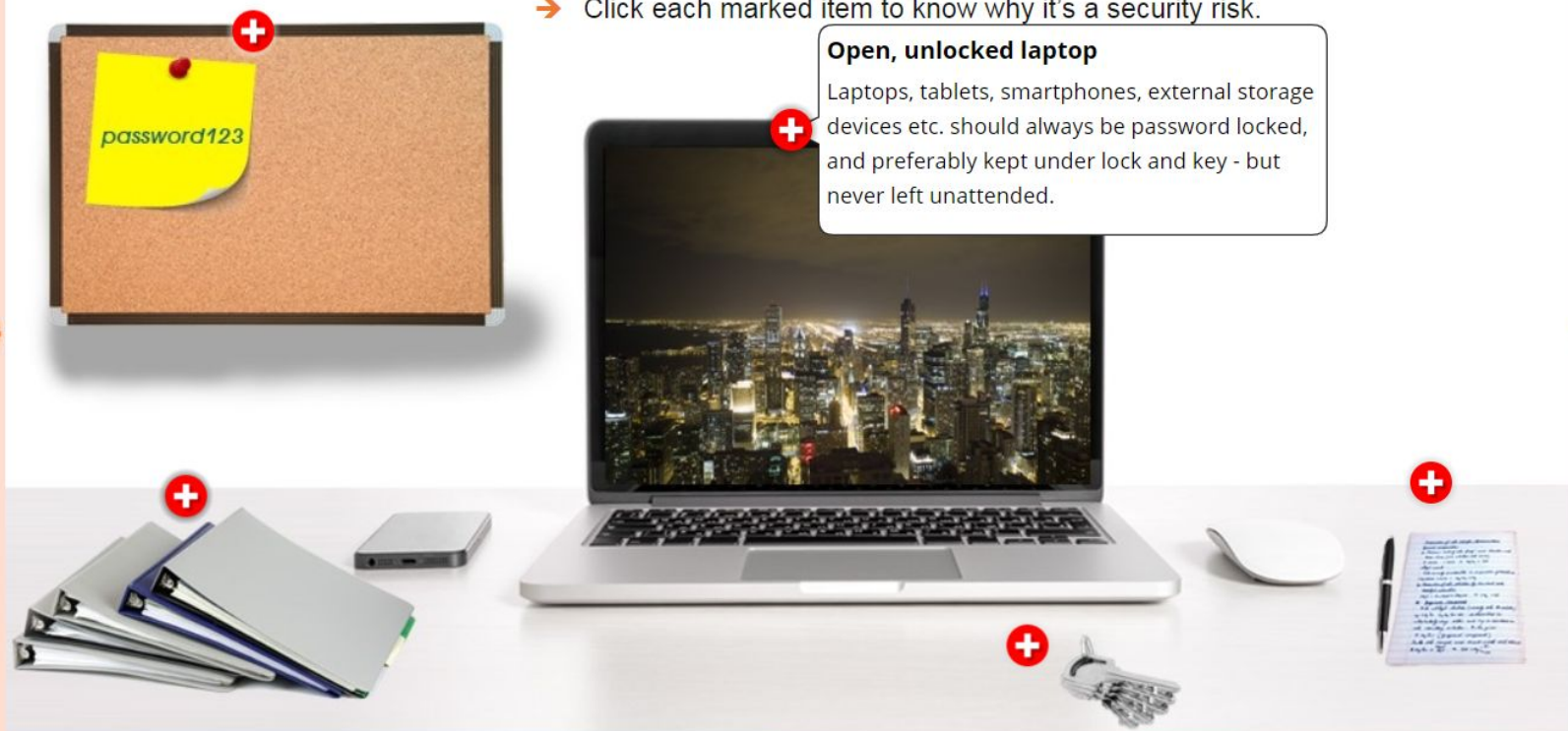
# Clear Desks and Clear Screens



# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns

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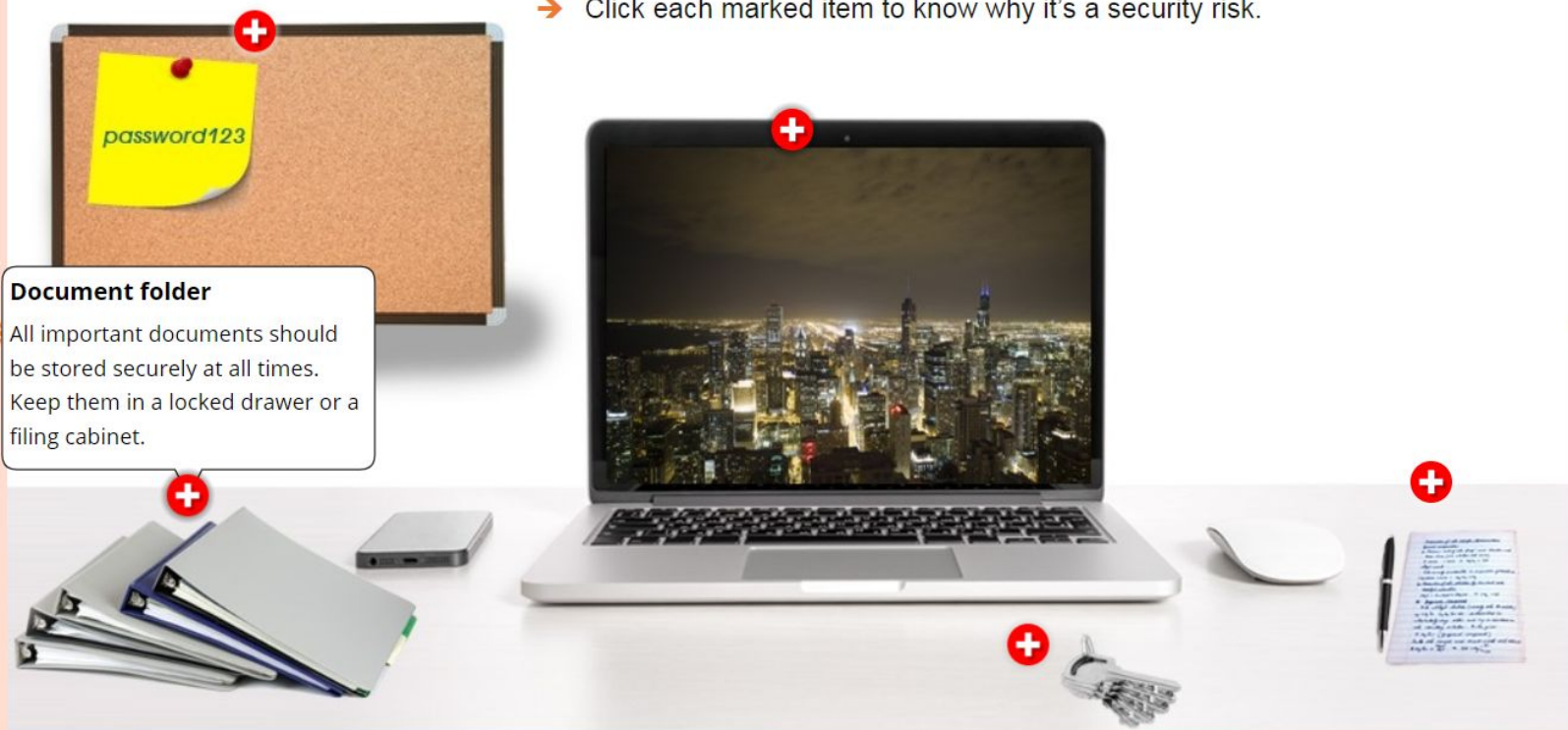




# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns

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### Document folder

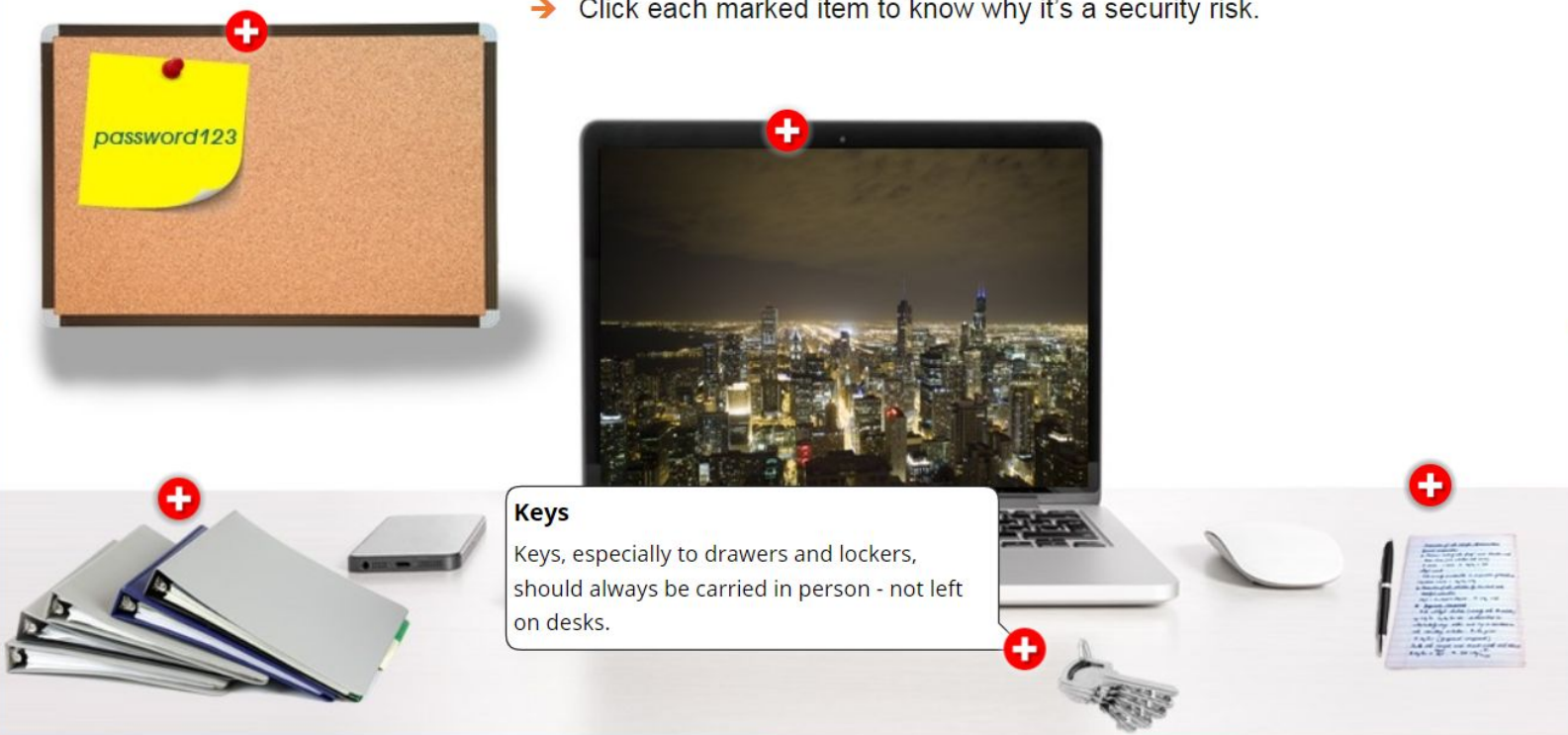
All important documents should be stored securely at all times. Keep them in a locked drawer or a filing cabinet.



# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Security concerns

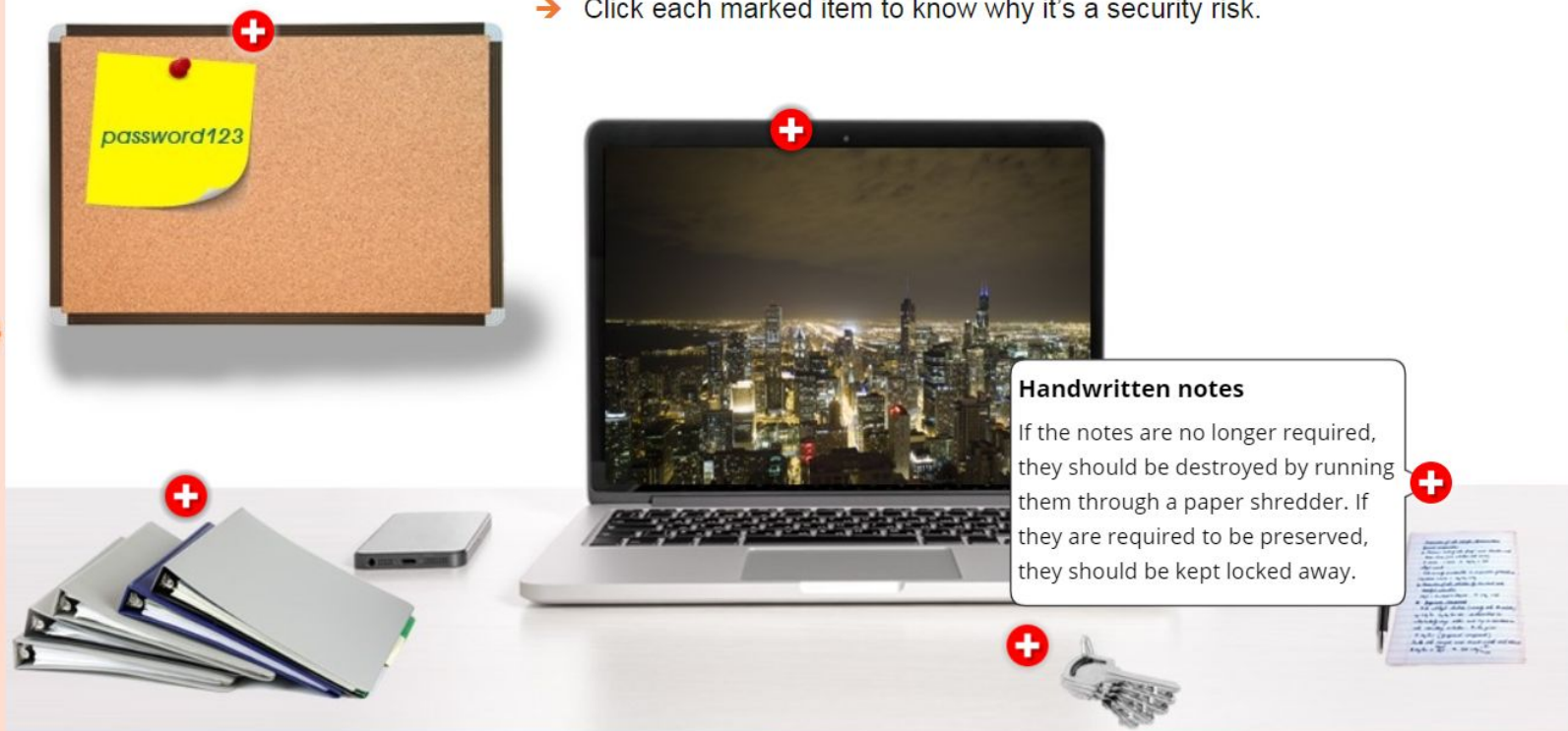
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# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

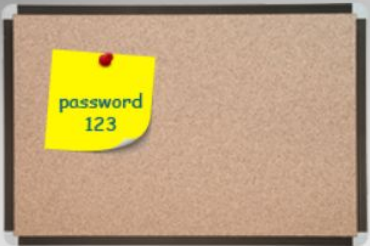
## Security concerns

→ Click each marked item to know why it's a security risk.



# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Let's help John out



→ Can you secure each item by dragging it to the correct security means?





SHREDDER

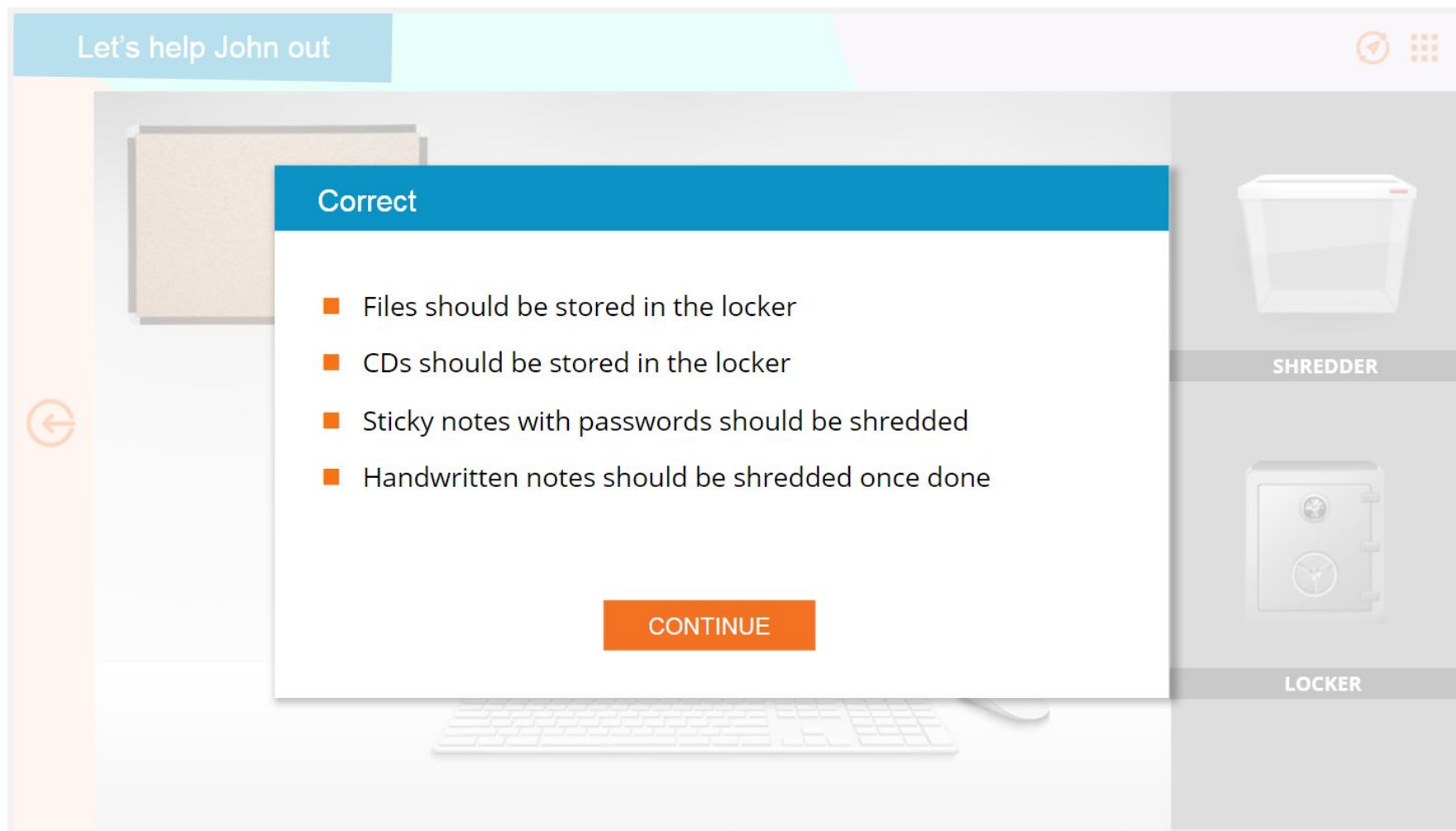


LOCKER





# Clear Desks and Clear Screens





# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Let's help John out



Great! Now that you have created the desk, let's focus on the computer. What should John have done?



Lock the computer

Leave it as it is

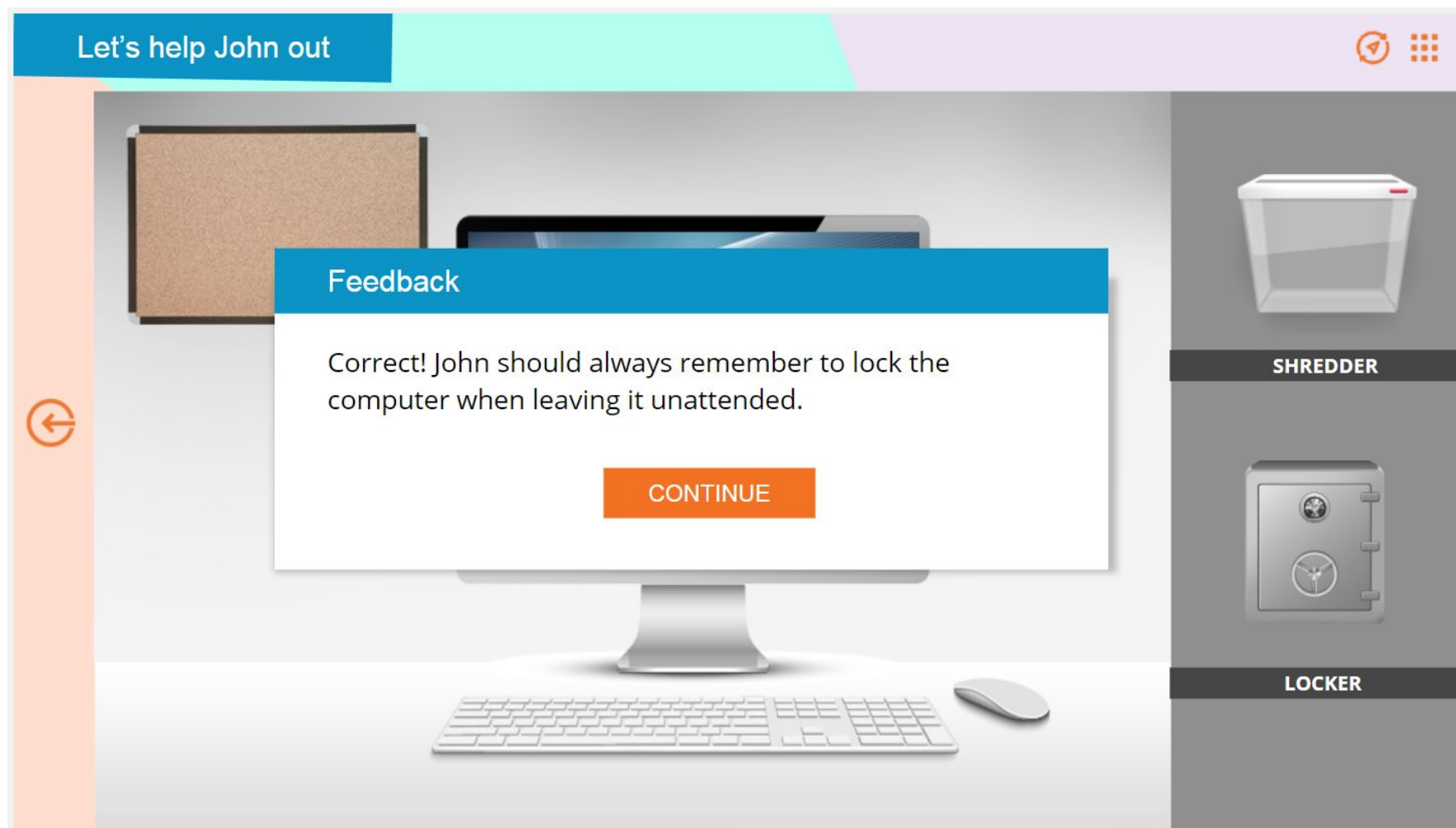


SHREDDER



LOCKER

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens



# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Benefits of a clear desk and a clear screen

Here are some benefits of a clear desk and clear screen policy.

➔ Click each element to know more about it.



Save Time  
and Money



Make Good  
Impressions



Discourages  
Prying Eyes



Reduce  
Stress



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A clean desk policy will encourage employees to use digital versions of documents, significantly reducing your organisation's costs of paper, ink toner, and printer maintenance.

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A clean and tidy workspace makes your organisation look efficient and presentable to anyone who decides to visit, including the auditors and also helps to demonstrate the end user's security awareness!



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Employees unintentionally leave sensitive information on their desk and computer desktop. Post-it notes are usually the worst culprit, containing names, phone numbers, and even user names and passwords visible in plain view. These habits encourage disgruntled employees, cleaning crews, and maintenance staff to view information they should not have access to and may lead to corporate espionage.

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When your employees are organised they can spend more time concentrating on work rather than feeling stressed because they can't find a report due in the next 10 minutes. Thereby, increasing their productivity.

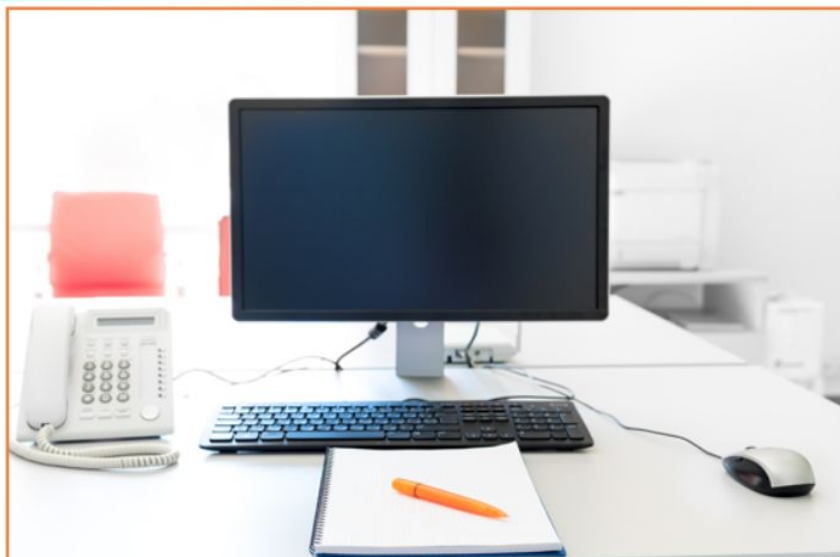
# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Some best practices

- Clear your desk and lock your computer, while leaving office
- Lock all drawers and file cabinets that contain highly confidential and sensitive information while leaving office
- Ensure safety of all physical and digital information, and assets
- Shred documents you no longer require

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

## Conclusion



That brings us to the end of this module. Now that you have learnt the importance of a clear desk and clear screen policy, you can help reduce data security risks in your organisation!

Take this quiz to check what you have learnt.

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens





# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Is the following statement true, or false?

It is absolutely fine to leave your computer screen unlocked in your own workspace, even when you are away.

☐ True

✓ ☒ False

NEXT

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens

You are working with some confidential documents, and you receive an urgent call to meet your manager. What should you do?

- ☐ Turn the pages over so nobody can read them
- ✓ ☒ Lock the documents away in your drawer, despite the emergency
- ☐ Ask your colleague to look after them while you are gone

NEXT

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens



When you set a password, you should:

- ☐ Write it down
- ☐ Tell your colleague, in case you forget it
- ☒ Commit it to memory, and destroy any written occurrences

NEXT

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens



Before leaving office for the day, you should:

- ☐ Keep the next day's work documents stacked on your desk
- ☐ Keep your computer unlocked so others can use it if necessary
- ☒ Switch off/lock your computer, and clear your desk of all documents

NEXT

# Clear Desks and Clear Screens



If there's an important document you no longer require, you should:

- ☐ Keep it, so you can use the blank, reverse side for writing notes
- ☐ Crumple it and throw it in the wastepaper basket
- ✓ ☒ Shred it

NEXT